

Odisha Gram Panchayat Development -- Analytical Findings Report

Department of Panchayati Raj & Drinking Water, Government of Odisha

Automated MetaInsight Analysis

Activity Lifecycle - Every Planned Work and Its Money

Spending Remains Below Both Plan and Sanction

The recorded difference between voucher-linked spending and planned cost is Rs -51.96 crore; the negative sign means spending remains below plan. This is not confined to a few locations: for 27 of the 28 asset groupings, the difference is spread across the 16 blocks rather than concentrated in a small set. Banking Facilities is the sole category with no clear block pattern.

For activities with sanction records, the difference between spending and sanctioned amounts is Rs -5.02 crore. This is likewise spread across all nine districts for 27 asset groupings, rather than pointing to one district as the sole source of the divergence. District and block reviews therefore need activity-level reconciliation across the sample, not only scrutiny of the largest locations.

Status records show where much of the planned amount remains. Activities recorded as Activity Approved account for Rs -41.61 crore against plan and 79.6% of all activities. This pattern holds in 18 Gram Panchayats; **Boipariguda** and **Laxmipur** do not show a clear status-level pattern. The only positive status-level total is Rs 18,797 for WORK COMPLETED, which represents 0.1% of activities. With only 17 completed activities recorded, this does not establish repeated positive overspending by particular Gram Panchayats.

Infrastructure Dominates Planned Untied Funding

Theme 6 - Self-sufficient Infrastructure in Village carries Rs 30.07 crore of planned untied funding, or 50.4% of the total, against 36.9% of activities. It is the leading theme in 18 Gram Panchayats. The exceptions require direct review: the Unmapped theme leads in **Boipariguda**, while Theme 4 - Water Sufficient Village leads in **Kalimela**.

Technical sanctions are concentrated in sanitation and drinking water in every fiscal year. Sanitation has technical sanction recorded for 614 activities, representing 29.3% of all technically sanctioned activities, against 16.5% of planned activities. Drinking water has 538 activities, or 25.7% of technical sanctions, against 10.9% of planned activities. This shows where technical-sanction activity is concentrated; it does not establish whether other focus areas lacked approval, since

sanction records cover only part of the activity set.

Interpretation of planned tied funding is obstructed by missing descriptions for output types. The largest undescribed output category carries Rs 11.48 crore, or 65.0% of planned tied funding, against 28.5% of activities. A second undescribed category carries Rs 5.49 crore, or 31.1%, against 9.5% of activities. These two categories lead in 18 Gram Panchayats; **Dadhapatna** and **Dutimendi** follow a different pattern. The department must supply the output-type descriptions before officials can judge what this concentration represents.

Sanctioning and Recorded Spending Need Reconciliation

The Sarpanch is the recorded sanctioning authority for 62.8% of the 2,101 sanction-linked activities. For these records, the difference between spending and sanctioned amounts is Rs -3.24 crore, the largest authority-level negative position in every fiscal year. This requires reconciliation of sanctions and voucher-linked expenditure under the dominant sanctioning office, rather than being treated as an isolated-year issue.

Chikilli records Rs 0 in sanctioned funding across every fiscal year, while accounting for 5.0% of planned activities. The data cannot distinguish between no sanctioned amount and no sanction entry. Officials should establish which of these is true before drawing a delivery conclusion.

Voucher-linked expenditure is overwhelmingly attached to ongoing works. WORK ONGOING accounts for Rs 28.59 crore, or 93.9% of the Rs 30.43 crore general component spent, while ongoing works represent 16.6% of activities. **Boipariguda** and **Laxmipur** again do not show this clear status pattern. Spending is also recorded against abandoned works—Rs 1.15 crore, or 3.8%—which warrants activity-level checking.

Evidence on File

There are 8,267 geotagged photo uploads across 1,675 activities. New/Fresh works account for 6,893 photo uploads, or 83.4%, broadly in line with their 87.0% share of activities. Maintenance accounts for 1,268 photo uploads, or 15.3%, against 9.5% of activities. Officials should assess evidence coverage work by work; upload totals alone do not show whether each spent activity has adequate evidence.

At the next review, the officer should ask: Which high-value activities in each block make up the Rs -51.96 crore position against plan and the Rs -5.02 crore position against sanction, and what action is recorded for each? In **Chikilli**, were no amounts sanctioned, or were sanction records not entered? Which Gram Panchayats repeatedly show positive spending above plan or sanction at activity level, and do their sanction records and geotagged photographs support that expenditure?

> **Reading note:** this view has one row for each of the **12,704 activities** the 20 Gram Panchayats planned, and three of its properties are features of the data rather than results. First, **costless activities** -- training, campaigns and services planned without a cost -- only began being reported in 2023-24, and they are 7,074 of the 12,704 rows, so activity counts rise about eightfold at that boundary for a reporting reason. Second, Sanction records exist for **2,101 of the 12,704 activities** (about one in six), so every sanctioned-basis figure -- sanctioned amounts, approval counts, and

overspend against sanction -- describes that subset only. An activity with no sanction record is **not** shown to be unapproved; it is shown to have no record on file. Third, only **17 activities are marked WORK COMPLETED** in the whole sample, so completion rates here measure recording practice, not delivery. Activity-count comparisons across FY 2023-24 reflect a change in reporting completeness (costless activities begin being recorded), not a change in activity.

Monthly Money Flows by Gram Panchayat

Payments remain concentrated at the year-end

Cashbook payments and receipts follow a recurring annual cycle, whether measured in rupees or voucher counts. March concentrates payments in every year. The pattern is therefore not one isolated closing-month surge: payment activity repeatedly bunches around the fiscal year-end rather than moving evenly through the year.

The same annual rhythm appears in both inflows and outflows. District and block officials should therefore show whether March vouchers relate to transactions initiated earlier and whether pending payments and receipts are being reviewed before the final quarter. Sanctions do not follow the same clear monthly pattern, although sanction counts rise when viewed by quarter and fiscal year. This difference in timing warrants scrutiny of whether sanctions and cashbook payments are moving through the GPDP cycle in an orderly sequence.

Bhubaneswar dominates voucher processing

Bhubaneswar block recorded 2,135 vouchers, accounting for 25.0% of the 8,529 vouchers in the full period. It had the highest payment-voucher count in five of the six fiscal years; 2024-2025 was the exception, when no block stood clearly apart.

This is a concentration of transaction volume, not by itself a measure of performance. Nevertheless, one block handling a quarter of all payment vouchers warrants a transaction-level review: whether the volume is spread across its Gram Panchayats and months, whether repeated small payments account for it, and whether March carries an unusually large part. At the other end, **Lahunipara block** recorded 181 vouchers and **Balisankara block** recorded 178 vouchers. These lower counts cannot establish weak delivery on their own; officials need to confirm whether fewer transactions were actually made or whether cashbook entry was incomplete.

District and block money flows do not rank alike

In 2025-2026, **Ganjam district** held the largest totals for several measures, including cashbook payments and receipts, but it also accounted for 26.1% of the 1,985 vouchers in scope. The more comparable measure is a typical month for one Gram Panchayat: Ganjam recorded Rs 7.78 lakh, based on 48 GP-months, while **Cuttack district** recorded Rs 7.58 lakh, based on 24 GP-months, and **Khordha district** recorded Rs 5.49 lakh, based on 36 GP-months. Ganjam therefore remains

prominent after allowing for the number of Gram Panchayats and months, but Cuttack is close on monthly payment intensity.

Within **Bargarh district**, **Bheden block** is the clearest cashbook outlier. A typical month for one Gram Panchayat recorded Rs 8.74 lakh in payments, compared with Rs 2.28 lakh in **Barpali block** and Rs 2.22 lakh in **Attabira block**. These averages cover 72, 144 and 72 GP-months respectively. Bheden also accounted for 57.2% of Bargarh's 1,546 vouchers, so part of its larger cashbook total is transaction volume. In contrast, Barpali recorded the highest sanction count and sanctioned amount in the district. The review should reconcile this difference between where sanctions are recorded and where cashbook transactions are concentrated.

Sharp shifts require record-level explanation

Ganjam district shows a marked break in August 2020 across cashbook payment and receipt amounts and counts. Its sanction count and sanctioned amount shifted in October 2020. These dates identify a change in the recorded series but do not establish what caused it. The underlying vouchers and sanction registers should be checked around these months to distinguish a genuine operational shift from a change in recording practice.

Questions for the departmental review

First, why does **Bhubaneswar block** account for 2,135 vouchers and 25.0% of all payment vouchers, and how are those vouchers distributed across Gram Panchayats and months? Second, in **Bargarh district**, how do officials reconcile Bheden's much higher monthly cashbook payments with Barpali's lead in recorded sanctions? Third, what changed in **Ganjam district** around August and October 2020, and do the underlying cashbooks and sanction registers confirm the shifts visible in the monthly data?

> **Reading note:** this view's time axis is the **cashbook's own 72 months** (April 2020 to March 2026), and a Gram Panchayat month with no transactions is present as a row of zeros rather than absent -- 259 of the 1,440 cells are such months. Two consequences follow. Sanctions are counted by **sanction month**, so the **2,040** sanctions dated inside the window are here and **61** dated outside it are not; the yearly report card counts the full 2,101 by fiscal year, and both totals are correct for their own axis. And **March concentrates payments every year** -- 2,040 of the 8,529 payment vouchers fall in a March -- which is the fiscal-year end, a known property of government cash flow. On activity-linked expenditure specifically: the cashbook's total outflow did **not** grow across these six years (**Rs 15.60 crore** in 2020-21 against **Rs 11.12 crore** in 2025-26), while the share of it carrying a link to a planned activity rose from **2.7%** to **53.2%**, and the number of recorded activity-voucher links rose from **30** to **2,122**. A rise in activity-linked expenditure is therefore a rise in recording completeness unless the cashbook total rises with it. A dated event overlaps this section: the period this finding is restricted to falls inside and the shift this finding reports falls in the months just after the COVID-19 first-wave lockdown (2020-03 to 2020-06). The national COVID-19 lockdown was imposed on 25 March 2020 and unwound in phases through June 2020. Public works and Gram Panchayat office operations across Odisha were restricted for most of that window. The dates coincide; this analysis does not establish that one produced the other.

Gram Panchayat Report Card by Year

Recorded Sanctions Are Declining in Most Districts

Recorded sanctioned amounts show a decreasing trajectory across fiscal years in Bargarh, Koraput, Cuttack, Sundargarh and Malkangiri. This is the clearest cross-district pattern in the yearly report cards and should be tested against each district's sanction registers and pending proposals.

Across the sample, the sanctioned amount was highest in 2020-2021 at Rs 6.13 crore, representing 21.2% of the Rs 28.84 crore recorded across all six fiscal years. It was Rs 5.51 crore in 2021-2022, or 19.1%, and reached its lowest annual level in 2025-2026 at Rs 3.57 crore, or 12.4%. The path was not uniformly downward: recorded sanctions stood at Rs 4.45 crore in 2022-2023, Rs 4.56 crore in 2023-2024 and Rs 4.63 crore in 2024-2025.

Kandhamal is the important exception, with an increasing trajectory in recorded sanctioned amounts. **Khordha**, **Ganjam** and **Rayagada** show no clear direction. These exceptions require different review questions: Kandhamal should explain what changed in its sanction pipeline, while the other three districts should account for the year-to-year movement GP by GP. As sanction records cover only a limited part of the activity base, the department must also establish whether these trajectories represent actual sanctioning or the completeness of sanction entry.

Bargarh's Activity and Delivery Measures Are Not Concentrated in One GP

Bargarh district contains 3,062 activities in this report card. The activity base is spread relatively evenly among Bheden at 27.4%, Hirlipali at 25.4%, Bandhpali at 23.8% and Bhatigaon at 23.4%. Several other measures—including expenditure, administrative and technical sanction counts, ongoing activities, activities with photographs and photograph uploads—are also spread across these four Gram Panchayats rather than concentrated in one.

This does not mean performance is satisfactory or that the signed differences between spending and plans or sanctions are small. It means that no single Gram Panchayat accounts for the pattern. Review action in Bargarh should therefore cover Bheden, Hirlipali, Bandhpali and Bhatigaon rather than treating one GP as the sole source of concern.

There are also important exceptions within Bargarh. The number of GPDP plans, sanctioned amount and completed activities show no common distribution across the four Gram Panchayats. Planned cost, costed activities, cashbook payments, cashbook receipts and abandoned activities follow a different distribution from the measures that are evenly spread. Officials should reconcile these differences at GP-year level: a broadly similar activity load does not establish that planned money, recorded sanctions and cashbook movement are aligned.

Photograph Evidence Must Be Tested Against Spending

In Bargarh, both activities with at least one geotagged photograph and total photograph uploads are spread across all four Gram Panchayats. This rules out a simple explanation in which evidence uploading is confined to one GP. It does not establish that expenditure is adequately evidenced: upload counts do not show whether the higher-value works, or the relevant fiscal year's spending, have photographs on file.

The review should therefore compare expenditure and evidence within each GP-year, especially where cashbook payments follow a different distribution from activity and evidence counts.

Questions for the Departmental Review

First, why do Bargarh, Koraput, Cuttack, Sundargarh and Malkangiri show decreasing recorded sanctioned amounts, and do district sanction registers confirm the same trajectory? Second, what accounts for Kandhamal's increasing pattern and the absence of a clear pattern in Khordha, Ganjam and Rayagada? Third, in Bheden, Hirlipali, Bandhpali and Bhatigaon, do GP-year records reconcile planned activities, sanctions, cashbook payments and geotagged evidence, or are approvals and photographs missing from the system?

> **Reading note:** this view is a full grid -- all 20 Gram Panchayats against all 6 fiscal years, 120 rows -- so a **zero is a recorded zero**, not a missing row. It can mean either that nothing happened or that nothing was recorded, and this view cannot tell those apart. **Completion recording effectively ceased after 2022-23:** the 17 activities ever marked WORK COMPLETED fall 3 / 6 / 6 across 2020-21 to 2022-23, then 0, 2 and 0 across the three years since. No comparison of Gram Panchayats on completions can be supported by this column, and trend patterns on it are reported in the data-quality annex rather than as findings. Sanction records exist for **2,101 of the 12,704 activities** (about one in six), so every sanctioned-basis figure -- sanctioned amounts, approval counts, and overspend against sanction -- describes that subset only. An activity with no sanction record is **not** shown to be unapproved; it is shown to have no record on file. ``n_tech_approvals`` totals **2,095**, not the 2,134 technical-approval records in the source: 39 sit on activities that have no administrative approval, and the approval view hangs the technical approval off the administrative one. The Ask chatbot reports the same 2,095, so the two systems agree.

Data-Quality Annex

This section is generated from the mining run's own record, not written up from the findings. It lists what the analysis declined to report as a finding, and why -- so that a column nobody is filling in is visible as a recording problem rather than absent from the report or, worse, present in it as a performance result.

Gram Panchayat Report Card by Year

- ``n_abandoned`` over `fiscal_year` carries too little non-zero data to support a time pattern: of the 46 series the engine would read, 28 fall below the guard (at least 4 non-zero points and at

least 33% of the series non-zero), with between 0 and 6 non-zero points each. The column is non-zero on 54 of the view's rows. A time pattern over a series that is mostly zeros describes the recording, so none is reported as a finding.

- **`n\_completed` over fiscal_year** carries too little non-zero data to support a time pattern: of the 46 series the engine would read, 42 fall below the guard (at least 4 non-zero points and at least 33% of the series non-zero), with between 0 and 4 non-zero points each. The column is non-zero on 7 of the view's rows. A time pattern over a series that is mostly zeros describes the recording, so none is reported as a finding.

- **`n\_costless` over fiscal_year** carries too little non-zero data to support a time pattern: of the 46 series the engine would read, 46 fall below the guard (at least 4 non-zero points and at least 33% of the series non-zero), with between 3 and 3 non-zero points each. The column is non-zero on 60 of the view's rows. A time pattern over a series that is mostly zeros describes the recording, so none is reported as a finding.
